

mixing and production later. It requires a full duplex soundcard and software that allows multi-track audio recording such as Acid, Cakewalk Sonar or Cool Edit Pro. Once you have set up your gear, you should start by laying down a click track (a track with a simple rhythmic beat). Everyone records his or her individual part separately to the cue of the beat. The advantage of recording this way is that everything is on its own separate track, so you can alter the volume and equaliser settings and pan any individual part, or re-record it until you get it right, or even get rid of it altogether, without affecting any of the other recorded tracks. The downside is that it's harder for your band to groove together and throw in improvisational bits, but it does ensure that everybody stays on the rhythm.

Accessories you need: A full duplex soundcard and a mixer (the M-Audio Audiobuddy; Price: \$160/approx Rs 8,000)

Scenario 3: The best of both worlds

This combines scenarios 1 and 2, and comes closest to how recordings are done



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“Unless you have a professional soundcard with multiple inputs and outputs, and separate microphone presets or a mixer, you're better off recording track by track”

in a professional studio. Each instrument can be recorded individually, or all together at one time. You'll need an ATI 8MX2 Mic Preamp/Mixer and a soundcard with multiple ins, such as the M-Audio 2496. The difference is that you are using an outboard mixer with separate outputs on each channel (instead of just a single stereo line out), which is hooked into a recording device with multiple ins. This

means the whole band can play together, but everything gets recorded on its own track. You can derive the benefits of scenario 1 (live/spontaneous sound), as well as of scenario 2 (total control over each individual track). This kind of setup costs much more since the recording system needs to be multi-track all the way, but it provides you more flexibility to record that perfect song.

Accessories you need: A full duplex soundcard; a soundboard/ mixer with multiple ins (Mackie 1202-VLZ Pro; Price: \$399/approx Rs 20,000, ATI Preamp Mixer; Price: \$2,995/approx Rs 1,50,000, Shure SM58 Microphone; Price: \$69/approx Rs 3,500)

Choosing the software

For purely techno or dance music, you can start off by using a fully featured multimedia PC loaded with a software synthesizer such as Reason or Rebirth, or a sampler such as eJay. No musical skills are required—all you need to do is play around with the sound samples and interface controls, and before you know it, you

Recording with Cakewalk SONAR 2.0

Let's step through the process of setting up and recording your first track using Cakewalk SONAR 2.0.

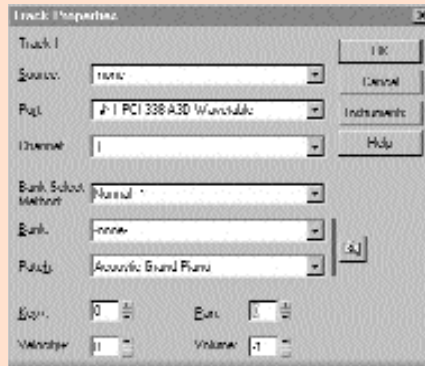
STEP 1 Configuring Cakewalk SONAR 2.0:

Start by setting up your MIDI ports (see box 'Jargon Buster'). Go to **Options > MIDI Devices** and choose the ports you want to use for your MIDI input and output. Here the MIDI input port is the port through which SONAR receives MIDI information if you have a musical keyboard. The MIDI output is the port to which the MIDI audio signal is directed. Choose the Wavetable port for output as this results in much higher fidelity MIDI sounds.



Configure the MIDI input and output ports

STEP 2 Preparing a track: Before you feed in the notes into a track, you need to set certain parameters to it. Right-click on



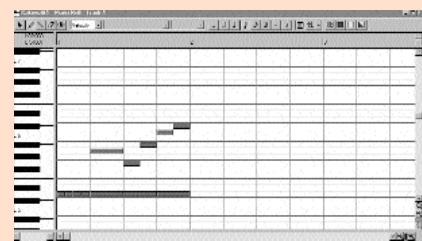
Choose the instrument from the Patch menu

the first track in the Track view and set the Channel number. As a rule, set it to the same number as the track you are working on. Then select the instrument you would like the track to play from the Patch dropdown box. You can choose from a wide variety of instruments such as the acoustic grand piano, violin, etc.

STEP 3 Feeding in notes: If you are well-versed in musical notation, the Staff view is where you should feed in notes. If you have no formal training in music but possess a good ear, choose the Piano Roll

view—you can click and create notes in this panel in the form of bars.

The most efficient way to feed notes is through a MIDI-capable musical keyboard. In the main Staff view, simply press the 'R' button on the track to which you want to feed in notes—this arms the track. Then click on the Record button on the bar and play away.



Feed in notes in Piano Roll view

STEP 4 Fine tuning: Finally, when it all comes together, you can configure the volume for each track, and add the chorus and the reverb effects through the Console view.

STEP 5 Playback: After you've created all your tracks, go back to the beginning of the song, and hit the Play button (or the [Spacebar]) and you have your first MIDI recording!